



Crash

DANAROV
SAFEEN
SURCHI

To

Cash

Crash To Cash

By:

Danarov Safeen Surchi

Type:Novella

Genre:Comedy

Crash to Cash

Chapter I

.Hello. I'm Tommy

Some people call me Tommy the Silly.

.Others prefer Tommy the Unlucky

And on very generous days? Tommy the

.Funny

.Personally, I think all three fit perfectly

Luck and I have never been on speaking

.terms. It avoids me like I owe it money

Still, I've always been a positive guy. If life trips me, I try to land in a way that makes
.people laugh

At school, that was kind of my job—
.unofficially, of course

.Bad day? Call Tommy

.Boring class? Look at Tommy

Existential crisis at age sixteen? Yeah... still
.Tommy

.And somehow, I liked it that way

.So... last day of school

Freedom was in the air. No homework, no exams, no teachers saying “this will be
”.important for your future

I was walking back home feeling like I had
.just escaped prison—with honors

I was so happy, I started dancing in the
.street

Not normal dancing either. I mean full
.performance

Spins. Steps. A little shoulder action.
.Probably illegal in three countries

.People were staring

.I assumed it was admiration

I kept going—completely lost in my own
victory parade—until I reached the main
.road

.Now, a normal person would stop

Look left. Look right. Maybe think about
.survival

.Not me

I stepped forward like the main character I
...believed I was

completely unaware of the very real, very
.fast car heading straight toward me

—And then

.BOOM

.Everything went black.

Chapter II — Three Days After

Morning came slowly... like it wasn't sure I
.deserved it

Sunlight slipped through the curtains in thin,
lazy lines, cutting across my room like quiet
knives. Dust floated in the air, glowing gold
.in the light. Everything felt... still. Too still

.Then the pain arrived

.Not dramatic. Not heroic. Just real

.Heavy. Dull. Everywhere

.I opened my eyes

.My ceiling. My room. My bed

.Good news: I was alive

.Bad news: I immediately regretted it

.I tried to move—big mistake

My legs were wrapped in thick bandages,
elevated like they were royalty, surrounded
by bottles, pills, and medical stuff that all
.screamed you messed up, Tommy

Nice,” I muttered. “Upgraded to deluxe ...“
”.suffering

.But something felt... off

.Not just the pain. Something else

.Something in my head

I frowned and lifted my hand, pressing my palm against my temple. I squeezed slightly, like I could physically grab whatever was .wrong and pull it out

”?...What the hell is this feeling...”

—Before I could figure it out

.The door opened

My sister walked in like she owned the place. Which... unfortunately, she kind of .did

She was smiling, carrying a tray with my favorite breakfast—warm, golden pancakes drenched in honey, with a side of soft .scrambled eggs and tea

.Yeah. She knew me too well

She wore a kitty-pink pajama set, an oversized hoodie hanging loosely off her

shoulders, and a small necklace resting
.against her neck

—And the moment I saw it

.Something clicked

.Not a memory. Not a thought

.More like... information

.Clean. Sharp. Instant

.Material. Cut. Quality. Value. Fake

.My eyes narrowed slightly

”—What the...”

.I blinked, confused

“Idiot. Since when do you care about jewelry

I shook it off. Whatever. Probably brain
.damage

.She walked closer, smiling warmly

”...Finally awake, sleepyhead“

.She paused, studying my face

”?So? How do you feel“

.I had a headache that felt personal

Annoyed, half-dead, and deeply offended by
:existence, I muttered

”.I don’t get worse... and I hope I never do“

She sat beside me, completely ignoring my
.suffering like a professional

”.Eat“

.I stared at her for a moment

.Then I obeyed. Survival instincts

A few quiet moments passed as I started
.eating

:Then I asked

”?Where’s Mom“

.She bit her lip... clearly trying not to laugh

.That was my first warning

Well..." she said casually, "she's at "
".school

.My brain froze

!School

.No

—No no no

.A cold wave of fear hit me

!Had I been out that long

!A week? A month

!A year

.My heart started racing

No—no no NO—please tell me you're "
"—lying—please

She burst out laughing, covering her mouth
.with the back of her hand

...And just like that

.I realized

...

.I had been played

.Hard

.I looked at her, completely dead inside

You bitch... you almost gave me a heart “
”.attack

.Big mistake

She instantly grabbed my ear and yanked me
.forward

.Pain. Immediate. Personal

”.Apologize“

Her voice was calm. Too calm. Fake rage.

.Real grip

.I folded instantly. As always

Ow—ow—OK OK I'm sorry—let go, you “
”—devil

.She released me with satisfaction

”.Good boy. Now eat“

.I went back to eating like a defeated soldier

...But

.My eyes kept drifting back to her necklace

.I couldn't stop

.That weird feeling again

.Numbers. Value. Quality. Fake. Cheap

The words formed in my head without
.permission

:Before I even realized it, I asked

”“Where did you get that“

.She glanced down at it casually

”.This? Oh... my boyfriend gave it to me“

.My face twisted automatically in disgust

.It always did when she mentioned him

I don't know why. Probably protective
.brother instincts

.Or maybe he just had a punchable face...

.I narrowed my eyes slightly

”“How much did he spend on it“

.She blinked, confused

Why? Since when do you care about my “

”“boyfriend... or my jewelry

.I rolled my eyes

”.Just tell me the price“

.She studied me for a moment, then shrugged

”He didn’t say. Said it was a surprise“

.I didn’t like that answer

.At all

If you sold it... how much would you “
”want

.Even I didn’t understand why I asked that

.The words just came out

.She frowned

”Who said I’m selling it“

.I sighed, getting more annoyed

”.Just. Tell me. The price“

:She blinked again, then said

”.dollars √...“

.I didn’t hesitate

”I’ll give you 100. Give it to me“

.Silence

She stared at me like I had just grown a

.second head

.Honestly... same

Okay... take it,” she said slowly. “But why “
do you even care? You’ve never cared about

”.stuff like this

.I looked away, annoyed

...Because the truth was

.I didn’t know

”.Not your problem“

.She stood up, calm as ever

Without asking, she took off her necklace
and placed it on my drawer like it meant
nothing. Then she opened the drawer—my
.drawer—and pulled out the money

.My money

.A whole year of saving

As her fingers moved past the bills, I
.panicked

Hey—if you take even one dollar more, “
”—I’ll

.I stopped

Because we both knew I wouldn’t do
.anything

.She glanced at me

That look. The “you’re adorable when you
.try to be scary” look

But thank God—seriously, thank God—she
.didn’t push it

She took exactly 100 dollars. Not a cent
.more

Then she walked out like a queen who had
.just completed a fair trade

.The door shut behind her

.And just like that... silence

.I looked at the drawer

.Then at the necklace

.Then back at the drawer

.Strangely... I wasn't upset about the money

.Not even a little

Instead, a weird thought settled in my
—mind

.I feel like I have a hundred million dollars

.I blinked

”?What...”

.It didn't make sense

.But the feeling was real. Solid. Certain

Like I knew something... even if I didn't
.understand it yet

When the echo of the door faded, I
straightened myself slowly, ignoring the pain
in my legs, and fixed my eyes on the
.necklace

.Focus

—The moment I did

.Something hit me

.Not physically

.Mentally

.Like waves

Information flooding in... too fast, too
.messy

.I frowned

”؟...Slow down... what is this...”

I grabbed my notebook from the drawer, my
.hand slightly shaking

.If this was real, I needed to understand it

.Piece by piece

.I stared at the necklace again

.Focused

.Forced my mind to organize the chaos

—Then

:The first clear thought formed

.This necklace is Russian

.I froze

”؟What...”

.I focused again. Harder this time

.Two minutes passed. Painfully slow

:Then another piece clicked into place

.It was made in the 1700s

.My breathing changed

.This wasn't guessing

.This wasn't imagination

.This was knowledge

I clenched my jaw and focused one more
—time

...And suddenly

.Everything aligned

.Clear. Fast. Complete

Lost during the Russian communist
revolution... passed through the chaos of
both World Wars... disappeared for
decades... rediscovered in the 1990s after
the fall of the Soviet Union... transported
.through Europe... ended up here

.My hand tightened around the pen

Crafted with genuine gemstones... not
.cheap, not fake... real

.My heart started pounding

—Then the final piece dropped

.The price

.Clear. Precise. Unshakable

.Estimated value: around 180,000 dollars

.Silence

.I slowly lowered the notebook

”No way...”

.Seventy-five dollars

That idiot boyfriend thought it was worth
.seventy-five dollars

.I looked at the necklace again

.Then laughed

.Quiet at first

.Then wider

.Then... a little insane

I gently placed the necklace back into the
.drawer, almost respectfully this time

.Then leaned back onto my bed

.Staring at the ceiling

.Counting seconds

.Waiting

.Healing

—Because the moment I could walk again

.I wasn't going back to school

.I was going to sell that necklace

And change my entire life.

Chapter III

.I stayed in that bed for a long, long time

Long enough to become the most annoyed
.guy on Earth

Days blurred into weeks. Weeks dragged
.into months

—And before I knew it

.It was October

.Fully recovered

.Which meant... school was back

I stared at the ceiling that morning, feeling a
.mix of relief and pure anger

.I had lost my entire summer

.Gone

.All because of one stupid car crash

”Unbelievable...”

—But then

.I smiled

‡Because now

.I wasn’t just unlucky Tommy anymore

.I was talented

That morning, I tried walking properly for
.the first time

.No cane. No support

.Just me

...Step

...Step

—Step

.It worked

.I froze for a second, then grinned

”Let’s go...”

I walked out of my room and into the dining
.area

Mom and my sister were in the kitchen,
.making breakfast

Dad sat at the table, reading the newspaper
like the calmest man alive, as if nothing in
.the world could ever surprise him

.I cleared my throat slightly

”Hey... good morning“

.They all turned at once

.And just like that—the room lit up

.Smiles. Surprise. Relief

.I was walking

My mom rushed over immediately, gently
holding my arm like I might break again at

any second. She guided me to a chair and sat
.me down carefully

“My sister

.She didn’t guide

.She commanded

:She placed the plate in front of me and said

”Eat, boy“

.And God help me if I refused

—She wouldn’t cook eggs

.She’d cook me

.So yeah... I ate

Properly. Respectfully. Like a good, law-
.abiding citizen

When I finished, I stood up, took my dishes,
and placed them on the counter like a very
.responsible human being

.My sister was washing dishes

She leaned her head back slightly, shoulders
relaxed, and gave me a sideways glance with
.a small smile

.Didn't say a word

.That was worse than talking

.I cleared my throat

”.I wanna go out“

My dad didn't even look up from his
.newspaper

.Classic

”.You still need healing, boy“

.I shook my head

”.No. I'm okay now“

My mom hesitated for a second, then smiled
.softly

”Alright, son... but be careful“

.I nodded

—Then turned and walked back to my room

My always messy, completely unorganized,
.disaster of a room

.I started getting dressed

.Blue baggy jeans

.Oversized orange shirt

.White sneakers

.Simple. Perfect. Legendary

...Then

.I opened the drawer

.The necklace was still there

.Waiting

I picked it up slowly... then, without
.thinking, kissed it lightly

It was still close to my lips when I
:whispered

”Finally, girl... let’s get rich“

I slipped it into my pocket and walked out of
.the house

.No hesitation

.No second thoughts

...Step by step

—I made my way down the street

Heading straight toward the Russian jewelry
.shop

.RussaKovacs

I walked through the city for the first time in
.months

...After being stuck in bed for so long

.Every step felt alive

The air felt fresher. The noise felt louder.

.Even the sun felt warmer

.I smiled like an idiot

‡Because today

.I was about to become rich

.Very rich

I pushed open the door and stepped into the
.shop

.A small bell rang

Behind the counter stood a girl in her mid-
twenties—the receptionist... or maybe the
.shop assistant

.She looked at me... and paused

.Confused

.Yeah, I get it

A teenager. Cheap clothes. Nothing about
.me screamed money

She leaned forward slightly and said
:politely

”“Welcome, sir. How may I help you“

.I nodded calmly

Good morning, ma'am. I'm here to buy... a “
”.1700s Russian antique gemstone necklace

.Silence

.For a second, I thought she'd laugh

.She almost did

.Almost

She held it in—but the confusion stayed on
.her face

Sir... are you sure you're in the right “
”place

.I nodded

”Yeah. Why do you ask“

.She smiled

.Not a kind smile

.A mocking one

Nothing. So... you want a Russian 1700s “
”.necklace. Gemstone

She turned around, grabbed a few necklaces,
.and placed them on the desk

”.Here you go, sir. That's what we have“

.I looked at them casually

.Then picked one up

”“How much“

.She didn’t hesitate

”.Those are all 250,000 dollars“

.I almost smiled

.Caught you

.The real value was around 180,000

.She was trying to overprice me

.Too bad... I wasn’t normal anymore

I placed the necklace back down gently and
asked

”“Do you buy items as well“

.She nodded slowly, still amused

”.Of course“

.Perfect

...I reached into my pocket

.And pulled out the necklace

.I placed it on the desk

Then leaned slightly forward and said with a
:hint of mockery

So... ma'am. This is exactly what I asked “
”.for

.I looked her straight in the eyes

”“I assume I’m getting 250,000“

.Her expression changed instantly

.She looked at the necklace

.Then at me

.Then back at the necklace

.Her jaw dropped slightly

.She blinked

.Then tried to recover

And... how can you prove it is what you “
”?claim

.I shrugged

You have permission to show it to Mr. “
”.RussaKovacs

.She hesitated... then nodded

”.Very well“

She grabbed the necklace and walked
.quickly toward the office

.Three minutes passed

.Longest three minutes of my life

—Then

.The door opened

.And he came out himself

.Mr. RussaKovacs

.Old. Sharp. Dangerous

.Easily in his eighties

A man who had spent over sixty years
.dealing with jewelry

.He looked at me like I was a ghost

”“Where did you get this, boy“

.I leaned back slightly, calm

”“Is that a problem“

.He narrowed his eyes

”“.Maybe. Maybe not. But answer me“

.I shrugged

”“.Bought it from my sister“

.That confused him. A lot

”...Your sister...? Hm“

.He stopped himself

Doesn't matter. How much do you want for “
”“it

.I didn't hesitate

”.Your employee said it's worth 250,000“

.He slowly turned his head toward her

.That look alone was a threat

.Then he looked back at me

.Calm. Controlled

”.Or walk away .۲۰۰,۰۰۰“

.I scoffed

”.That's an insult ؟۲۰۰,۰۰۰“

Yeah... it wasn't. But he didn't need to)
(.know that

.He nodded once

Then we're not buying it. Have a good “
”.day

.He turned away

.Trying to pressure me

.Trying to break me

.Cute

I grabbed the necklace and turned toward the
.door

.One step

—Two

”.Wait“

.There it was

.I turned back slowly

.He looked... different now

.Less confident

”.Fine. 250,000“

.I crossed my arms

”No. I’m not selling anymore“

.Silence

—Then

”۲۸۵,۰۰۰“

.There it was

.I smiled

”.Sold“

.I placed the necklace on the desk

...Moments later

I walked out of that shop with 285,000

.dollars

.Just like that

.Outside, I couldn’t stop smiling

—Behind me, inside the shop

.The girl looked at him, completely stunned

”“Did he just... win over you“

.Mr. RussaKovacs sighed, annoyed

”.Yes. He did“

.Then he looked at her coldly

”.And you’re fired“

...

.I paused outside for a second

.Then laughed

”.Damn...“

.I just became rich

.And accidentally ruined someone’s career

.Not bad for my first day back

.I walked out of the shop trying to act normal

.Failed

.Completely

“Because inside

.I was exploding

.More than 200,000 dollars in my pocket

.Me

.Tommy the Unlucky

”Damn...”

—But then

.My smile slowly changed

—Because one thought hit me

.This isn’t enough

.I stopped walking

.Looked at the sky

.It wasn’t even midday yet

”Yeah...”

.I turned

.Time to work again

.I headed downtown

.Not the nice part

.The real part

.The poor shops

.The shady ones

The “you didn’t see anything” kind of
.places

‘Illegal stuff

.Probably

‘Did I care

.Not even a little

I pushed open the door of a small, dusty
.shop

.A weak bell rang

.Inside, everything looked... cheap

.Messy shelves

.Old glass displays

.Random junk everywhere

!Prices

.dollar... 10 dollars... maybe 50 at most \

.Perfect

.I walked slowly, scanning everything

.Focusing

.Letting that strange ability guide me

—Then

.I saw it

.A crown

.Small, worn, but... wrong

.It didn't belong here

It rested on a dusty velvet cloth, slightly
tilted, like even it was embarrassed to be in
.this place

.The gold was faded but rich

Thin arches curved upward, meeting at a
.small cross at the top

Tiny gemstones—deep red and dark green—
were embedded along the band, some
.chipped, some missing

...But the craftsmanship

.Ancient

.Precise

.Royal

.My mind clicked instantly

.Byzantine

.Imperial era

Worn by a minor noble... possibly linked to
.a regional king

.My heart started beating faster

.This was big

.Very big

I walked to the counter where an old man
.sat, half-asleep

”“Hello, sir... how much is that“

.I pointed at the crown

.He squinted at it

.Clearly clueless

”“.That old thing? ...45 dollars, son“

.I almost laughed

.He thought he was overpricing me

.Forty-five dollars

.For something worth a fortune

.I didn't argue

.Didn't hesitate

.I paid instantly

.Grabbed the crown

.And walked out

...But this time

.I didn't go to a shop

.Too risky

.Too illegal

—Instead

.I went somewhere smarter

.The Greek consulate

—Because if there's one thing I knew

.Greeks don't play about their history

When I reached the entrance, a guard
.stopped me immediately

.Firm grip on my arm

”“Where are you going, boy“

.I stayed calm

”.I want to meet the consul“

.He frowned

”“Why do you need to see Mrs. Eleni“

.I gave a small smile

Because I have something valuable for “

”.Greece

...He studied me for a moment

.Then nodded

”.Alright. Follow me“

...Inside

.It didn't feel like a normal office

.Too clean. Too organized. Too important

.He pointed to a seat

”.Sit there. Wait“

.I sat

.Trying not to look excited

.Failed again

—A few minutes later

.A man walked out. Not the woman

.Assistant, probably

.Didn't matter

—All I cared about was

.Money. Money. Cash. Cash

.I stood up and walked toward him

.He looked at me, slightly confused

”“You wanted to give us something“

.I nodded

Yes. I have something important for the “

”.Greek government

.He waited

.I didn’t waste time

...I pulled out the crown

.And placed it on the counter

—The moment he saw it

.Everything changed

.His eyes widened

.His breath paused

.He didn’t even try to deny it

His gaze flickered between me... and the

.crown

.Then he spoke carefully

The Greek government owes you... a “
”.special thanks

.I raised a hand slightly

”.No thanks. Just give me the money“

.He blinked

.Confused... but also relieved

.Good

.Less talk. More cash

:He thought for a moment, then said

”“One million dollars“

.I tilted my head

”.I think it’s worth more“

.He smiled

.Not offended

.Impressed

”Good. Then three million“

.Pause

”And I’m sorry... we cannot offer more“

.I didn’t even think twice

”.Deal“

.A few papers

.Some signatures

.Easy

.Because I knew it was real

.No doubt

.No fear

When it was done, he took the documents
:and said

”Thank you. Truly. This means a lot to us“

—Then

.The sound of a money counting machine

.Beautiful

.Absolutely beautiful

.He handed me the cash

”.Have a good day“

.I nodded

.Took the money

.And walked out

...Outside

.I stopped

.Looked at the bags

.Then laughed

”.What the hell...“

—In less than four hours

.I made over 3.2 million dollars

.Tommy

.The unlucky guy

.Yeah. Right

...But then

.My smile slowly faded

.Because a new problem appeared

.A serious one

‘How do I hide this from my family

—Or worse

‘How do I explain it

.I sighed

”.I’ll figure it out...”

.Yeah

.Hopefully

.I started walking home
...With millions in my hands
.And absolutely no plan

Chapter IV — Siege of the Kitchen

.I stood in front of my house door
.Thinking
.Yeah... thinking
‘Impressive, right
.I don’t usually do that
.But today? My brain was working overtime

...Because I had millions on me

.And no explanation

”.Alright,” I muttered. “Act normal...”

.Like nothing happened

.Easy

“Right

.I walked inside

.Straight to the kitchen

.Mom was there, cooking

.Perfect. Start simple

”“Mom, what do we have for lunch“

:She answered kindly

”.We’re having dolma“

.I nodded seriously

”.Good. I like that“

.Yes. Focus on food. Safe topic

—But then

.The question came

.The killer question

”?Anyway... where did you go“

...

.There it is

The life-ending, truth-exposing, career-
.destroying question

.But I was ready

.I had a plan

.A name

.A clean lie

”—I was with Ver“

”.Don’t lie“

...

.My sister

.Of course

.Sitting there. Scrolling. Watching. Waiting

Verona was here earlier. He came to see “
”.you

...

.She almost caught me

.Almost

.But she made one mistake

.She didn't let me finish

:So I looked at her calmly and said

”.I'm not lying. You didn't let me finish“

.Pause

I was going to say I was with Verona's "
".brother

.Silence

.Checkmate

.I smirked internally

.Dear sister... you can't ruin me every time

.She rolled her eyes

".Okay. Now fuck off"

.Victory

I grabbed a glass, drank water like a survivor
".of war, and walked out

.Mission complete

.Siege of the Kitchen: SUCCESS

.I went straight to my room

.Opened the closet

.Moved the mess around
.And hid the money deep inside
.Very deep
.Like... please God no one opens this deep
—Then
.Second mission
.I walked to the living room
.Grabbed my PlayStation
.Relocated it to my room
.Strategic positioning
.Mission Two: SUCCESS
.Lunch came
.I ate like a peaceful citizen
.Didn't say much
.Didn't act suspicious

Didn't think about the millions hidden ten
.meters away

.Nope. Not at all

After lunch, Mom stopped my sister from
.washing dishes

”You're not a machine. Go rest“

.My sister didn't argue

She went to the couch... phone in hand...
.soul gone

.I followed her and sat beside her

.Scrolling. Waiting. Planning

:Then I said

”Hey“

”Hmm“

”Wanna play FIFA“

”.No“

...

.That wasn't acceptable

.So I pushed

What? Afraid to lose 5–0 again? Like last “
”.time? Loser

.Boom

.Hooked

She instantly grabbed my ear and yanked me
.closer

”...I'll play. But if I win“

.Oh no

You'll wear my kitty jeans... one of my “
”.bras... and let me record you dancing

...

.Pain. Fear. Regret

”—Ouch—OK OK—DEAL—LET GO“

.She released me

”.Good. Bring the controller“

.I scratched my head

Uh... I moved the PlayStation to my “
”.room

.She didn’t say a word

—She grabbed my collar

.and dragged me—

.Like a criminal

.Inside my room, she turned it on

.Threw the controller at me

”!Hey! That could break“

.She smirked

”.Don’t worry. It’s not your leg“

...

.I almost laughed

.Almost

.But then I got serious

.This was the moment

”Hey... I need to tell you something“

.She rolled her eyes

What? You confessed to Leyla and she “

”rejected you

”!No! Something else, idiot“

.She looked at me. Curious now

”Fine. I promise I won’t tell anyone“

.Worst promise ever

.But I went for it

...I stood up

...Opened the closet

.And threw the money onto the bed

”I made 3.2 million dollars this morning“

.Silence

.She blinked

.Once

.Twice

—Then

.She grabbed my ear again

.Hard

”!‘WHO DID YOU ROB“

OUCH—I DIDN’T ROB ANYONE—LET “

”—ME EXPLAIN

.She narrowed her eyes

”.Explain. Carefully“

.So I did

.Everything

.The crash

.The feeling

.The knowledge

.The necklace

.The crown

.The deals

—When I finished

.She laughed

.Actually laughed

”“You’re saying you’re... talented“

”.Yes“

.More laughter

.I raised my hand

I swear to God. Quran, Bible, Torah, “
”—whatever you want

.She stopped laughing

.Thinking now

”.I’ll believe you... on one condition“

”“What“

”.Wait“

.She left

.I stood there

.Nervous

.Very nervous

.Then she came back

.Holding a bracelet

.She looked at me like a judge

”“Alright, Mr. Talented. What’s this worth“

.I looked at it

.Focused

.Easy

Fake. Looks nice though. 10 dollars. Maybe “
”.8 if you negotiate

.She froze

.Then grabbed another one

”?And this“

.I checked again

”.98 dollars. Not 100“

.Silence

.Now she believed

...Slowly

”?How“

.I shrugged

”I don’t know“

—Then

.She hugged me

.Tight

.Unexpected

:She pulled back, held my face, and said

You brought home THREE MILLION and “

”!‘you’re acting like it’s nothing

”—Hey—calm down“

”!I CAN’T“

.She was glowing with excitement

:Then I said

”.We have a problem“

.She narrowed her eyes

”?What“

”“How do we explain this to Mom and Dad“

.She paused

.Then smiled slowly

.Dangerous smile

”I have an idea“

”“What idea“

”.After dinner“

...

.I trusted her

.That was my first mistake

.After dinner, she came out dressed to go out

”.Dad, Mom—I’m going out“

.Dad looked at me

”.Take your brother with you“

.She smiled

.Suspiciously

.I followed her outside

.And she explained the plan

.Simple

.Clean

.Terrifying

.We went out

.Ate. Drank. Laughed

...Honestly

.It was nice

.First time in a long time

.Maybe she wasn't that bad

...

.Okay, she was still bad

.But less

.At night, we came back

.She sat next to Dad

.Nervous

Dad... do you remember when we went to “
”“Italy last year

.He nodded

”“Yes. Why“

.She took a breath

”.I found a necklace in the mountains“

.Pause

”.Tonight, Tommy and I sold it“

.Another pause

”.For 3.2 million dollars“

.Silence

.Complete silence

.Mom froze

.Dad stared

.I stared

.Even I was impressed

...

.Wow

.Lying really is in our blood

.And it worked

.Perfectly

...We were officially

.Millionaires

.I leaned back slowly

.Watching their reactions

—And one thought crossed my mind

.They're definitely going to take my money

Chapter V — The Little Rat Bids

.Yeah

.My money got taken

.Absolutely taken

.Gone. Finished. Family-approved robbery

‡Did I care

.Nope

‡Why

.Because I was talented

—Money wasn't something I had anymore

.It was something I could make

...And to be fair

Mom gave me some money back to “buy
”.things for myself

“So technically

.I got robbed... politely

—Eight months later

.We were rich

”.Not “comfortable

”.Not “doing well

.No

.Rich

.Everyone was working in something

.Dad expanded business

.Mom managed things

My sister... controlled half the house like a
.dictator

!And me

—On my birthday

.Dad gave me a restaurant

.Yeah

.A whole restaurant

”.Happy birthday, son. Here’s responsibility“

...

.Cool

.One evening, I was heading back from work

:Which basically meant

.Buying. Selling. Scamming scammers

.Normal day

.Then I saw it

.A large building

.Fancy. Loud. Important

—And outside

.A girl

.Around my age

.Short silver hair. Sharp eyes

.Confident

.Pretty

And definitely the type who thought the

.world belonged to her

.I stopped walking

—And a thought crossed my mind

How does it feel... to win something others

are fighting for

.I smirked

”Let’s find out...”

.I walked toward the entrance

.Two guards stopped me immediately

Hey, boy. Where do you think you’re “
”going

”.This isn’t a place for you“

.I looked at him calmly

”.I want to join the auction“

—They looked at each other

.Then laughed

”.Yeah... no“

—I was about to respond

:When I heard a voice from inside

Mr. Cominsall offers 210,000. Any higher “
”bids

.My eyes sharpened

.Perfect timing

—Before anyone inside could speak

:I raised my voice

”!210.000 and one cent“

.Silence

.Heads turned

.The lawyer looked straight at me

”?Who are you, boy“

.I met his eyes

”?A client. May I come in“

.He scanned me

.Judged me

.Rejected me

”.No“

—At that exact moment

:The silver-haired girl spoke

”.215.000“

.The lawyer nodded

Miss Markford offers 215,000. Any “

”—higher

”.215.000 and one cent"

.Now he was annoyed

”“What do you want“

.I smiled slightly

”.The same thing everyone else wants“

”“And how will you pay“

”.Cash“

.That did it

”.Take him out“

.The guards grabbed my collar

...I sighed

.Then slipped each of them 200 dollars

.Instant loyalty shift

.They let go

“Corruption

.Beautiful thing

—Inside, the bidding continued

”!250.00“

:I stepped forward and shouted

”!250.000 and one cent“

.Now the girl turned around

.Our eyes met

.She looked annoyed

”“You’re still here, little rat“

.I stayed calm

”.Careful, ma’am. You might lose to a rat“

.Her eyes narrowed

.She turned back

”.290.000“

.I didn’t hesitate

”.and one dollar 300.00"

.She scoffed

:Then raised it sharply

”.500.000“

.Then she looked at me again

”.Now leave“

.I smiled slightly

”...Impressive. That’s a lot of money“

.Pause

”for someone like you...”

—Then I raised my voice

”!999.999“

.Silence

.The room froze

.The owner didn’t even hesitate

”?...Sold! To Mr“

.I stepped forward

”.Tommy. Just Tommy“

”.Sold to Mr. Tommy“

.I pulled out the money

.One million

.Placed it on the table

...The owner handed me the necklace

.And one dollar back

.I took both
—Turned around
.And walked past her
—But right before I passed
.I gently grabbed her hand
.Opened her palm
.Placed the dollar inside
:And said calmly
”A gift... from the little rat“
.I let go
.And kept walking
—Behind me
”!Jerk! You’re absolutely a jerk“
.I didn’t turn
.Didn’t care

—All I knew was

...I just spent one million dollars

.On a necklace

.I didn't even need

.Didn't even plan to buy

...

—But somehow

.It felt perfect

—As I walked home, one thought hit me

I really hope my parents don't find out about
.this

Final Chapter — Every Crash Means Something

.As I walked home, the night felt normal

.Too normal

...I had bought the necklace for fun

!But were they all playing for fun too

...

.I didn't think so

.I just didn't know it yet

—Not far away

The silver-haired girl stood, furious,
.breathing fast

.She grabbed her phone and called

Dad... someone outbid us. I sent a guard to “
”.follow him

.Silence

—Then

.Rage

”!‘WHO“

Her father's voice exploded through the
.phone

I will finish you if you don't bring that “
”!necklace to me

.She froze

I've searched for it for forty years... “

”!FORTY YEARS

.His voice dropped—cold, dangerous

”.You don't lose it because of some... boy“

.The call ended

—And somewhere

.A decision was made

.I knew nothing

.Not about her

.Not about her father

Not about the men already moving toward
.me

.I got home

.Sat on the couch

.Controller in my hand

.Game on

.Life... normal

.For a moment

.Mom came and sat beside me

—Her voice soft, warm

”“How are you, my boy“

.I kept my eyes on the screen

”—Not“

.Gunshots

.Loud

.Violent

.Real

.Glass shattered

.Walls cracked

.Screams filled the house

—My heart stopped

.Then started racing

.Too fast

.Way too fast

.More bullets

.More noise

.Fire

.They burned it

.They burned everything

—I tried to move

.But something hit me

.Darkness swallowed me whole

—When I opened my eyes

.Sirens

.Voices

.Chaos

.I was on an ambulance bed

.My head felt like it was splitting apart

—A sharp, pulsing pain

.Like lightning striking inside my skull

.I grabbed the nurse weakly

”What... happened to my family“

.She didn't answer

.Not immediately

.She hesitated

.Then forced a smile

”.They'll be fine“

...

.I knew that tone

.It wasn't truth

.It was mercy

.Hospital ceiling

.White

.Cold

.Empty

.Just like the feeling growing inside me

.Then a police officer walked in

.Slow steps

.Heavy silence

...He looked at me

.With pity

.I already knew

.But I still asked with my eyes

”...I’m sorry, son“

.The words hit harder than any bullet

”...Your parents... your sister“

.Pause

”.They didn’t make it“

.Everything stopped

.Sound disappeared

.Time broke

—Then it came back

.As pain

.Raw

.Violent

.Uncontrollable

.I screamed

.I cried

.I broke

Nurses held me down as if I was falling
—apart

.Because I was

—Two hours later

.There were no tears left

.No voice left

.No warmth left

.Only one thing remained

.Understanding

...Every crash

.Means something

.The first crash gave me luck

.Money

.A way up

!This crash

.Took everything

.Burned everything

.Destroyed everything

.So it must give me something in return

.I sat there

.Eyes empty

.Heart cold

—And for the first time in my life

...I smiled

.Not out of joy

.But out of certainty

”...I’ve got a new talent now“

.My voice was quiet

.Dead calm

”.Revenge“

